LANDLORDLEDGER · LANDLORD LAW WATCH · FREE CHECKLIST

CITY RENTAL RULES CHECKLIST

GRE Downtowner LLC v. City of Seattle, Wash. Ct. App., Oct 26, 2026. Early stage: nothing proven.

THE NEWS

- [ ] Owner of a 254-unit Seattle building (about $39M invested) sued the city
- [ ] Says combined rental rules (screening, roommate, winter eviction limits and more) took its property value
- [ ] Appeals court let the takings claims go forward. Not a win yet.

LANDLORDS: KNOW YOUR LOCAL RULES

- [ ] Screening limits (criminal history, income source) _____
- [ ] Eviction timing limits (winter, school year, etc.) _____
- [ ] Rent increase notice period _____ Relocation payments? _____

KEEP RECORDS

- [ ] Written criteria, used the same way for every applicant
- [ ] Dates of every notice you give
- [ ] Rule changes in your city this year _____

BEFORE YOU BUY A RENTAL

- [ ] Read the city's landlord rules first, not after closing
- [ ] Budget for compliance costs and longer vacancies
- [ ] **BONUS: what happens next in the case: Part 2 on the page**

General information only, not legal, tax, financial, or professional advice. Rules vary by state and city.
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